Sarah Sherman

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SUMMARY

UX researcher and strategist with deep experience in leading all aspects of research studies end-to-end, including generative and evaluative research for B2C and internal enterprise experiences. Skilled in moderated and unmoderated usability testing, in-depth interviews, screener development, and participant recruiting. Proven record of success in synthesizing research data into actionable insights.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Loan Origination and Customer Acquisition Aug. 2023-July 2026
Caribou Financial

- Led evaluative end-to-end research to redesign prequalified offers page in Caribou's customer-facing application; partnered with engineering, design, legal, and data science. Transformed the page from desktop-first to mobile-first and highlighted best offers, improving page throughput by 6% (absolute)
- Defined recommendations for a new experience with lead-generating partner Credit Karma after competitor and quantitative research and stakeholder alignment; when launched, the new experience accounted for additional 213 funded loans over 30 days.
- Led end-to-end research studies from recruitment to final readout and recommendations for a new agent-facing loan-origination system. Pre- and post-launch research led to direct iterations and system improvements, and a relative 13.2% lower document delay rate, 8.4% lower average talk time, and 10.7% decrease in talk minutes per approval versus the standard workflow.

Lead Design Strategist Sept. 2019 - Aug. 2023
Oportun

- Defined and led research strategy, including end-to-end execution of all studies, for the beta launch of the Oportun native mobile app, including customer interviews, unmoderated testing, and competitor analysis. After 14 months in production, the app processed more than 26k payment transactions; ~65% of all users made multiple in-app payments.
- Led generative research to develop pre-launch strategy for Oportun’s secured personal loans. Ran on-site interviews at Oportun retail stores with ~20 customers to understand customer perceptions and sentiment and drive in-store and digital presentation of the secured personal loan product.
- Delivered Oportun's first Collections-focused service blueprint and actionable recommendations to reduce agent error and exposure to regulatory fines by up to 30%. Research included system testing, 15 agent and stakeholder interviews, 30+ call and screen recording reviews, review of 2500+ agent scorecards, and survey responses from 40 agents.
- Owned UserTesting onboarding, system training, recurring vendor management, and testing practices for the Design Strategy team. Coordinated with team’s Dovetail owner to maximize efficacy.

Analyst | Senior Digital Designer June 2015 - Aug. 2019
GEICO

- Built and launched a suite of conversational applications to quote and sell insurance for digital and phone system (IVR) tools using IBM Watson for renters and auto insurance application flows. Owned requirements, research, testing, metrics, and delivery.
- Conducted research, ran experiments, and launched new experiences for chatbots on geico.com, enabling customers to self-serve and quickly find their way to critical functionals like filing a claim or making payments.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Information | University of Michigan Ann Arbor
Bachelor of Arts, English Language and Literature | University of Maryland College Park